

Here is a concise guide to setting up your environment and managing your repository.

1. Environment Setup (NPM)

Before running the site, you must ensure all "engines" (libraries) are installed. Run these in your project terminal:

- **Install Dependencies:** ```bash`
`npm install`
Do this whenever you download the project for the first time or add new features.
- **Start Development Server:**
`Bash`
`npm run dev`

This provides the local URL (e.g., `http://localhost:5173`) to view your site. It updates in real-time as you save code.

2. Git Workflow (The 3-Step Process)

To save your work and send it to GitHub, use these three commands in order:

1. **Stage:** Gather all your changed files.
`Bash`
`git add .`
2. **Commit:** Create a "save point" with a descriptive label.
`Bash`
`git commit -m "Describe your changes here"`
3. **Push:** Upload your local "save points" to GitHub.
`Bash`
`git push origin main`

3. Handling Errors (The "Rejected" Push)

If GitHub says your push is **rejected**, it means the online version has files your computer doesn't. Fix it with a "Pull":

- **Sync with GitHub:**
`Bash`
`git pull origin main --rebase`

- **Then Push again:**
Bash
git push origin main

Summary Checklist

- **Blank Screen?** Check the terminal for errors and ensure npm install finished successfully.
- **Changes not appearing on GitHub?** Ensure you finished the push command and saw a "Total [number]" success message.
- **Verify Status:** Type git status at any time to see which files are saved and which are not.